

Plugin play!

It's now time to install a plugin using Pathogen! For starters, let's install a colour scheme called 'kolor'.

Note: Please ensure that you are in the 'bundle' directory and only then run the command as shown below. This is really important. If you are in the 'autoload' folder, either move back to 'bundle' or just open a new command prompt and move to 'bundle'. Then run the command:

```
git clone https://github.com/zeis/vim-kolor
```

```
C:\Users\Admin\vim\vimfiles\bundle>git clone https://github.com/zeis/vim-kolor
```

```
Cloning into 'vim-kolor'...
```

```
remote: Counting objects: 67, done.
```

```
remote: Compressing objects: 100% (34/34), done.
```

```
Uremote: Total 67 (delta 21), reused 66 (delta 21)
```

```
Unpacking objects: 100% (67/67), done.
```

```
Checking connectivity... done
```

```
C:\Users\Admin\vim\vimfiles\bundle>
```

If all goes well, you should see something similar to the snippet above.

How did I get that path? I searched Github for Vim colour schemes, clicked on one of the search results, and copy pasted the URL after the 'git clone' command.

If you prefer a light background colour scheme, try out 'eclipse' using the methods mentioned above. Another one is called 'Molokai'. Try that out too. Now, reopen gVim and type the following in 'command mode':

```
:colorscheme kolor
```

Similarly, try ':colorscheme eclipse' and/or ':colorscheme molokai'.

Tab completion works in command mode so you don't have to type in the whole thing.

gVim will forget the settings the moment you close it. Let's tweak our `_vimrc` further so that the settings are maintained, and while we are at it, add a little more functionality.

Add the following lines to the `_vimrc`, just below the lines we added earlier so that it looks like the snippet below. Let's set the colour scheme, font and other settings. This is an exact replica of my `_vimrc` and I've been using it for about a couple of days without any issues, so this should work. If you need more information on any of the settings, either type ':h setting' in the gVim command prompt or search on the Net.

```
"Personal Settings.
"More to be added soon.
execute pathogen#infect()
filetype plugin indent on
syntax on
```

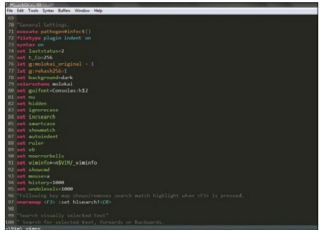


Figure 7: vimrc in gVim

```
*Set the status line options. Make it show more information.
set laststatus=2
set statusline=%F%m%r%h%w\ [FORMAT=%{&ff}]\ [TYPE=%Y]\
[POS=%l,%w][%p%]\ %{strftime(\"%d/%m/%y\" -\ %H:%M:%S)}
```

```
*Set Color Scheme and Font Options
colorscheme kolor
set guifont=Consolas:h12
```

```
*Set line no, buffer, search, highlight, autoindent and more.
set nu
set nu
set hidden
set ignorecase
set incsearch
set smartcase
set showmatch
set autoindent
set ruler
set vb
set viminfo+=n$VIM/_viminfo
set noerrorbells
set showcmd
set mouse=a
set history=1000
set undolevels=1000
```

Save the `_vimrc`. Reopen gVim and type* ':e \$VIM/_vimrc*' in command mode.

If the options are added correctly and there are no conflicts, your gVim will now appear as shown in Figure 7, with a nice dark background and syntax highlights. 

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The author is an open source enthusiast who loves dabbling with Linux and other open source tools to find ways of automating boring repetitive tasks (but seldom succeeds at it). Drop him a line (or two) about any doubts, questions or opinions about this article at pmu.nvx@gmail.com